



Umut Eren Demirci

Game Designer — Systems · Levels · Progression

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Portfolio: umuterendemirci.github.io

Game designer coming to games from twelve years of teaching English and designing courses, with a background in linguistics. I design difficulty curves, progression and systems that players can read at a glance, and I check them with data and playtests: for my mobile games **Arcana Siege** and **Arcana Match** I built bots that play the real rules to tune difficulty, and for **The Mouth of Silence** I designed a constructed language as a puzzle system. I work in Unity and Unreal Engine 5 (Blueprints), Excel and design documents.

Projects

Arcana Siege · match-3 tower defense for mobile · Unity 6 · play: ueren.itch.io/arcana-siege 2026 · personal project

- Designed a hybrid-casual puzzle defense: every tile colour fires a tower. Four towers, seven enemy types (armour, shields, healers, a splitting brood), a 1-of-3 upgrade draft with bad-luck protection, 12 sieges in four realms, permanent upgrades, a daily siege and a rewarded second chance.
- Tuned with bots that play the shipped rules at set speeds: fast random swiping won 95%, so armour now makes reading the road matter (22%); the first siege lands at 64% (target 55–65%); a career bot shaped the campaign into a sawtooth.
- Set the art and audio direction from a study of Kingdom Rush, Royal Match and Empires & Puzzles; documented it for a publisher: GDD, flowcharts, balance workbook, a 15-second ad storyboard with CPI go / kill criteria and a KPI plan.

Arcana Match · tarot match-3 for mobile · Unity 6 · play: ueren.itch.io/arcana-match 2026 · personal project

- Designed the whole game: 85 levels on a Fool's Journey map, 11 board shapes, three blockers, five special tiles and six combos, three boosters, a 78-card collection, and a story told by the Fool's dog, which I wrote.
- Built a balance simulator that plays the shipped rules: a spawn-weight sweep lifted stalled late levels (level 18 from 33% to 85%), and simulating all 85 levels exposed shaped boards and blocker gates as walls, which I retuned.
- Documented like a studio project: 22-page GDD, ten flowcharts, balance workbooks, card catalogue. Built with an AI coding assistant (Claude) in seven play-tested phases; 153 automated rule tests; playable on itch.io.

The Mouth of Silence · narrative puzzle adventure · Unity 6 · play: ueren.itch.io/the-mouth-of-silence 2026 · personal project

- A playable chapter of my novel: a scholar with no weapon reads *Kha'shul*, a constructed language I designed as the puzzle system (10 words, 5 grammar rules, one rule taught per puzzle, designed near misses instead of fail states).
- Designed a star-code navigation puzzle, a crew with personal movement and branching dialogue, and a campfire scene whose answers the final riddle calls back; rewrote the star chart after an outside playtest found it too obscure.
- Wrote every line of dialogue and narration from the novel's voice, and produced 343 voiced lines on a zero budget (open-source TTS, each character cast by ear). Autosave, a title screen, Windows and web builds on itch.io.
- Documented it as a studio project: 16-page GDD, a Kha'shul language reference, flowcharts and a script sample.
- Implemented with an AI coding assistant (Claude): I wrote the story and the language, designed the puzzles and the crew, and play-tested every build phase. 56 automated rule tests.

The Chronicles of Demise · narrative RPG concept · Unreal Engine 5 May 2025 – present · personal project

- Prototyped emotion-driven movement in Blueprints: trigger zones switch the character between Neutral, Anxious and Determined states, changing walk speed (500 / 150 / 800), braking and screen saturation, so the player feels the character's state instead of reading about it.
- Designed *The Temple of Vesta*, a level built around a "Trial of Slowness" that punishes rushing, and a "hard magic" system where spells cost health or gold.
- Adapting my own fantasy novel series, written since 2013 (100,000-word first book), into a game; built a painterly look test with an anisotropic Kuwahara filter.

Game deconstructions · Raid Rush (Panteon) and Royal Match (Dream Games) 2026

- Broke down each game's core loop, meta, economy and live ops from public data (patch notes, store listings, market estimates, player reviews), and proposed changes, each with a hypothesis, an A/B test design and guardrail metrics.

Tabletop RPG design · D&D 5e modules and world-building Dec 2022 – May 2024

- Wrote and ran adventure modules, adjusting encounters, pacing and rewards from what happened at the table.

Experience

Independent game development

May 2025 – present

- Portfolio work on the projects above while moving into game design; full-time since January 2026.

Private English Tutor · self-employed, Ankara

Jan 2024 – Jan 2026

- Planned one-to-one courses around each learner's level and goals, adjusting pace and difficulty lesson by lesson.

Visa and Education Consultant · TEOL and Bilimevi, Ankara (alongside teaching)

2023 – 2025

- Guided clients through visa and study-abroad applications, from first meeting to decision.

English Teacher and Course Designer · language schools and companies, Ankara

2014 – Dec 2023

- Taught English to groups and corporate clients for nine years, designing courses that introduce one new skill at a time on a rising difficulty curve and adjusting the pace from learners' results.

Skills

Design	Systems and balancing · difficulty curves and level pacing · progression and meta · economy design · live ops · game deconstruction and market analysis · narrative and puzzle design · dialogue writing · playtesting · GDDs and flowcharts
Tools	Unity 6 · Unreal Engine 5 Blueprints · Excel (formulas, charts, simulation data) · Mermaid / draw.io · Git
Languages	Turkish (native) · English (fluent)

Education

Ankara University · Linguistics (2017–2021); English Language and Literature (2013–2018)

coursework, no degree

Design documents

Arcana Siege	One-pager · GDD (12 pages) · Flowcharts · Balance and economy · Ad test and KPI plan
Arcana Match	One-pager · GDD (22 pages) · Flowcharts · Balance and economy · Card catalogue
The Mouth of Silence	One-pager · GDD (16 pages) · Kha'shul language reference · Flowcharts · Script sample
The Chronicles of Demise	Design sample: emotion-driven movement
Deconstructions	Raid Rush (6 pages) · Royal Match (5 pages)
Everything	umuterendemirci.github.io : builds, screenshots and all documents